

relying on a homogeneous system you hope will be right for you. We're also, just as importantly, identifying the weaknesses that might be apparent in your Money Type so that you can be aware of them and create behaviours and habits that limit their destructive force on your finances.

Once we understand our Money Story and our Money Type and create a suite of habits that are right for us, the power of this should be like a financial rip-current. Now, if you live by the beach, you'll understand that analogy; however, for everyone else let me quickly explain. Many of us understand that ocean safety is vastly different than pool, lake or river safety, and the thing about being caught in a rip, or a strong current pulling us out to sea, is that the actions we need to take are counterintuitive. Our instinct is to swim straight for shore, but instead we need to swim *with* the current in the rip, despite appearing to be dragged straight out to sea and to the dangers lurking there.

Creating a financial rip-current is about setting up systems that are custom-designed for our success rather than trying to fight against the current in our daily lives or the things we think we should be doing but are actually wrong for us. In other words, using the strength of the current to benefit us and to pull us along.

The truth is we can continue to beat ourselves up for not being disciplined, we can persist with investments that feel wrong for us, we can try to convince ourselves not to chase the herd, we can try to swim against the current. Or we can seek to understand ourselves and our behaviours, and set up processes that work with our strengths to protect and push us forward financially.

As you move through the following chapters, think about what you're naturally good at or how you're naturally predisposed to behave. As well as thinking about where you struggle and what feels unnatural to you.

Now, some of you, when you read that last sentence, answered, 'Money, full stop!' For some of you the concept of listing strengths and weaknesses when it comes to money feels too hard because to be honest you feel like you have a whole lot of weaknesses and not a whole lot of strengths. Or maybe you struggle to think about your strengths. That's part of the reason why we started with your Money Story, so you can think about why you feel that way and separate the story in your head from how you're